

because ultimately the student will be responsible for paying it back.

A similar situation can be found with entrepreneurs and real estate investors. Smart use of leverage in the form of debt can accelerate the growth and success of an entrepreneur or investor. But leverage is a double-edged sword that can amplify bad ideas and decisions, leading to disaster.

Successful entrepreneurs and investors aren't successful because they are daring risk-takers. They are successful because they first focus on adding value that others are willing to pay for. This was exhibited by Chad "Coach" Carson on the *ChooseFI* podcast.

Carson began his path to FI as a real estate investor and entrepreneur with no money or experience. This would stop most people dead in their tracks. But he had a desire to learn, a strong work ethic, and a lot of energy. As he described it, he was a "young pup" running around tripping on his ears. He just needed to find "old lions"—people with the money and experience he lacked—who no longer wanted to put in the time and effort he was willing to supply. He focused on how he could add value for them by putting in the work they didn't want to do, finding deals that they could share